CINEMA ▼

Girl, Uninterrupted

Bad Girl is a bold, empathetic portrait of a defiant young woman navigating love, failure and patriarchy while redefining what it means to be a 'good girl'



STUCK IN THE MIDDLE Anjali Sivaraman essays the role of Ramya in *Bad Girl*

"While you still live under our roof, you must obey us, and be a good girl," says Sundari (Shanthipriya) to her teenage daughter Ramya (Anjali Sivaraman). The reprimand, which sounds like a plea, comes after Ramya's dalliance with a classmate is exposed and she's expelled from school. Ramya, though, has other plans. "I will do as I like and deliberately do things that you dislike," she retorts, as she goes on to defy, to love and to fail, but always live life on her own terms.

Writer-director Varsha Bharath's female protagonist is less a rebel without a cause and more Greta Gerwig's *Lady Bird*, a young woman who wants to break free from the shackles of her family and society, and find herself. Only Varsha takes us on a longer, more fraught journey with her flawed and dynamic protagonist. Produced by filmmakers Vetrimaaran and Anurag Kashyap, *Bad Girl* (Tamil) offers a vivid portrait of Ramya from adoles-



THE LISTICLE

Theatrical and OTT releases to look out for



▲ **OCTOBER 16**

VRUSSHABHA

A bombastic, mega-budget period fantasy action drama. Malayalam megastar Mohanlal leads this juggernaut, shot and to be released in Telugu and Malayalam. Dubbed versions in Hindi and Kannada to be out as well. This is a story of generational conflict, destiny and myth told through two timelines focusing on the relationship between father and son. The promos promise grand visuals, spectacular battle sequences and royal scenery. Perfect for Diwali season.